

Cell Phones

Smartphones

Sony-Ericsson K700i

Specs: 65K colour screen, 41 MB built-in, tri-band, VGA Camera, Bluetooth and MP3 audio

Our Verdict: The K700i comes in a beautifully crafted body accentuated by the anodised silver finish. The translucent keypad, though cramped, gels perfectly with the body. The K700i from Sony-Ericsson is unarguably the most feature-rich phone in its category; name the feature and it's got it.

With features cramped into its small

body, the K700i wins over its closest competitors on the features it offers. The K700i comes with a brilliant 65K colour screen. The menu interface is sleek, and the browsing action is crisp without significant lag or jerks. The inbuilt camera is good for casual shots, and returns above-par picture quality. The MP3 player, though lacking in fidelity, comes in handy when on the move. Bluetooth makes transferring files and syncing your data a piece of cake.

Runner-up: **Nokia 6600**



Digital Cameras

Under 30,000 rupees

Kodak Dx-6490

Specs: 4 Megapixels, 10X optical zoom, 38-380 focal length, 1/1700–16 shutter speed and 16 MB memory

Our Verdict: The Kodak DX-6490 sports a pseudo-SLR look. The potential highlight of this camera is the 10X optical zoom engine that can zero in on to distant objects. The camera also has a small EVF (Electronic View Finder) which, when used, boosts the battery life to certain extent. The quality of the output is crisp,

vibrant and life-like. For the price it is offered at, the DX-6490 is a great buy.

It features in this list for its picture quality, features offered and for its excellent ergonomics.

Runner-up: **Sony Cybershot P100**



DVD Writers

Dual Layer DVD Writer

Pioneer DVR-108

Spec: 16X DVD+R, 16X DVD-R, 4X DVD+RW, 4X DVD-RW, 2.4X DVD+R DL, 32X CD-R and 24X CD-RW

Our Verdict: The Pioneer DVR-108 was the best Dual layer DVD writer that we have seen this year. The drive is featured packed and out plays most others except for the one from Asus. The DVR-108 supports over burning and hence can write DVD's above supported speed. On the performance

front it burns a Dual layer DVD under 27 minutes faster than most writers. Reasonably priced the Pioneer DVR-108 is the best DVD writer that money can buy.

Runner up
Asus DRW-1604P



Flashback To December 2000

ClickiT DCE-400

Specs: 1,024 x 768, 4 MB CF cord, USB, 4 AA batteries

Evolution: In the year 2000, digital photography was just taking its roots in India, and the ClickiT DCE-400 is a perfect example. The ClickiT DCE-400 was priced at Rs 20,000, and all it could do was take images at 1024 x 768 or 640 x 480, and probably could take it at 1.5 megapixels. In four years, digital photography has come a long way, and cameras much better than the ClickiT DCE-400 cost no more than Rs 10,000. Today, for Rs 20,000, you can expect a camera with a 4-megapixel CCD, 3x optical zoom, 4X

digital zoom and other advanced features related to white-balance, etc.

Pioneer DVD-1045Z

Specs: CD read 40x, DVD read 10x

Evolution: In the year 2000, DVD-ROM drives were the happening things: fast-forward to 2004, and we see DVD writers as the next big wave. Today, the Pioneer DVR-108 not only allows reading of DVD disks: one can also burn 4.3 GB of data onto a single disk. With dual-layer DVD drives making it to the market, you can write double that amount onto a single DVD.



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